

Jackson Creek Vegetation Restoration - Scoping Letter

USDA Forest Service - Cleveland National Forest - Descanso Ranger District

August 3, 2026

Dear Interested Party,

The Descanso Ranger District is proposing the Jackson Creek Vegetation Restoration project on approximately 1,250 acres of National Forest System lands in the Jackson Creek drainage, San Diego County, California (T15S R4E, Sections 10, 11, 14 and 15, SBBM).

Purpose and need: decades of fire exclusion have allowed dense, decadent chamise chaparral to encroach on coast live oak woodland, increasing fuel continuity near the community of Descanso. Non-native tamarisk and giant reed are displacing native riparian vegetation along Jackson Creek.

Proposed action: masticate decadent chaparral in units JC-01 and JC-02 (about 333 acres); hand-thin and pile brush around oaks in unit JC-03 (about 82 acres); manually remove invasive plants along the riparian corridor in unit JC-04 (about 88 acres). No herbicides and no new road construction are proposed.

We anticipate documenting this decision with a Categorical Exclusion under 36 CFR 220.6(e)(6), timber stand and/or wildlife habitat improvement activities.

Please send comments by September 8, 2026. A public open house will be held on August 20, 2026 at the Descanso Community Hall.

Sincerely, District Ranger, Descanso Ranger District